

S02-01 - The Fallout Investigation

Player read-aloud

The wreck tells a second story. Some damage is animal hunger. Some is not.

Scene summary

The party discovers clues that the strixwolf was not the whole story.

Visible choices

- Inspect body
- Search cart
- Follow tracks
- Move cart

Player questions

- What detail in The Fallout Investigation tells you the official story is incomplete?
- Who notices the human cost first, and how do they show it?
- What small object, smell, or sound makes this scene feel real?

Raw source

- Id: S02-01
- Act: Act Two
- Title: The Fallout Investigation
- Beats: Clue discovery GM-only truth Roll/check
- Image: assets/scenes/S02-01-the-fallout-investigation.png
- Short: The party discovers clues that the strixwolf was not the whole story.
- Long: The dead driver's neck was slit. The cart was stripped. Bramble and old shipping seals suggest deliberate interference with the route.
- Read: The wreck tells a second story. Some damage is animal hunger. Some is not.
- Gm: Give clues generously. The goal is not to hide the ambush forever; the goal is to let players feel clever before the trap springs.
- Entities: Vendor Cart Tamsin Vell Bramble Strand Torn Shipping Seals Route Ledger Cracked Pocket Ward? Tamsin's Home-Token Whitefire Custodian Strixwolf Mother Barnacle Keystone Asset Marlowe Fairwind Bramble Union Damage / Armor Sealed Keystone Crate Hush
- Choices: Inspect body Search cart Follow tracks Move cart
- Prompt: Adventurers investigate a ruined cart after the strixwolf has retreated; torn shipping seals, bramble snagged in spokes, contract tags, tracks into brush, dead driver; no strixwolf foreground, no undead.
- Source Entities: Vendor Cart Tamsin Vell Bramble Strand Torn Shipping Seals Route Ledger
- Beat Codes: clue-discovery gm-only-truth roll-check
- Slug: S02-01-the-fallout-investigation

- Act Title: Cargo Reclaimers
- Arc Role: External opposition and morally complicated conflict
- Caption: The cart scene becomes evidence of a claim war, not a random wilderness hazard.
- Image Alt: The Fallout Investigation scene art for Cargo Reclaimers.
- Image Prompt Used: Adventurers investigate a ruined cart after the strixwolf has retreated; torn shipping seals, bramble snagged in spokes, contract tags, tracks into brush, dead driver; no strixwolf foreground, no undead. Do not include the Strixwolf Mother, strixwolf pups, wolves, owlbeats, or animal companions unless explicitly requested. Do not include undead, skeletons, wraiths, Open Vale, the Custodian, or the Hanging Office. 4:3 cinematic fantasy concept art, no visible text, no captions, no logos, no UI, no watermark.
- Long Storyboard: The dead driver's neck was slit. The cart was stripped. Bramble and old shipping seals suggest deliberate interference with the route. Run this scene as external opposition and morally complicated conflict: The cart scene becomes evidence of a claim war, not a random wilderness hazard. Keep the camera close to practical choices, visible consequences, and the difference between ordinary people and the infrastructure pressing on them.
- Read Aloud: The wreck tells a second story. Some damage is animal hunger. Some is not.
- Gm Notes: Give clues generously. The goal is not to hide the ambush forever; the goal is to let players feel clever before the trap springs. Keep player-facing information actionable. Reveal systemic truth through objects, reactions, and consequences before naming it. Manufactured-threat lens: seed the contradiction, do not explain it. The surface goal stays simple and heroic.
- Sensory Details: mud drying around boot prints rope fibers stuck to splinters permit wax smelling faintly burned
- Body Language: Barnacle goes quiet when the route math fails Marlowe's face closes at the word 'claim'
- Sample Dialogue: Barnacle This was not a robbery. This was a message with bad penmanship.
- Checks: Knowledge Build the incident timeline. Standard Reveal Bramble involvement without flattening motives. 15 Cleanly resolve: Build the incident timeline. Add a concrete boon, extra clue, or improved position. Success, plus the player names one helpful detail or asks one follow-up question. Success, but the GM exposes a cost, ticks a countdown, or reveals a new pressure tied to The Fallout Investigation. The full goal slips, but the party still learns a useful truth or avoids the worst consequence. The GM makes a hard move that follows from the fiction and leaves the next choice visible. Spend Fear to separate true evidence from a tempting false read, or put the carriage/cargo under time pressure. On mixed or sliding results, reveal information in layers: visible fact, actionable clue, then systemic truth.
- Choices Consequences: Preserve evidence Later negotiation has leverage. Bramble Resolution improves. Pocket everything Useful clues, worse trust if discovered. Hush may read the party as opportunists.
- Clues: Torn Shipping Seals Cargo was targeted. The Keystone route was leaked. The seal was cut after the cart stopped.
- Loot: Torn seal Route ledger Bramble strand Tamsin's Home-Token: A small thumb-polished token on a cord hangs beside the torn blue scarf, warm from wear and etched

with a tiny house mark instead of a company seal. Cracked Pocket Ward?: A cheap little ward charm sits cracked down the middle, still trying to glow through a smiling warranty sticker.

- Payoff Flags: Bramble Union Resolution Track
- Filters: act-two bramble-union-resolution-track cargo-reclaimers choice clue-discovery gm-only gm-only-truth rollcheck clue faction manufactured-threat guaranteed-earned
- Index: 5
- Player Questions: What detail in The Fallout Investigation tells you the official story is incomplete? Who notices the human cost first, and how do they show it? What small object, smell, or sound makes this scene feel real?
- Relationship Prompts: Which PC quietly checks on someone else here? Who disagrees about the right thing to do without breaking trust?
- Ownership Prompt: Name one detail in The Fallout Investigation that belongs to your character's point of view.
- Reveal Hooks: Loreborne or Knowledge-focused PCs can read the institutional layer. Wildborne/community-focused PCs can read local custom and ecological stress. Martial/security-focused PCs can read threat posture and custody logic. Magic-focused PCs can feel ward tone, soul-signal, or spell instability. Loreborne: spots older legal, heraldic, or ward-craft language under the branding. Underborne: notices service doors, hidden routes, and who built the thing nobody credits. Highborne: reads etiquette, class panic, and reputational risk. Ridgeborne: notices stonework, weight, pressure, and structural weakness. Wildborne: reads the land, animals, and local ecological stress. Elf/Ribbet/Human/Giant/Katari: invite one sensory or social detail from the player's heritage. Sorcerer/Rogue/Warrior/Guardian/Ranger: give each class one table-facing way to shine without changing the plot.
- Fear Spends: Spend Fear to separate true evidence from a tempting false read, or put the carriage/cargo under time pressure. Close the ambush net or put a PC between cargo and a frightened reclaimer. Reveal a personal effect that makes victory emotionally complicated.
- Story Scope: Perceived antagonist: the forest. True antagonist: the corporate lie about the forest. The players never confront it directly. They are meant to feel it by the end. Every act offers at least one guaranteed and one earned hint that the danger is manufactured and the forest is not the enemy. The reclaimers target the cargo and manifest, not purses, and avoid killing when possible. REFLAVOR GUARANTEED Their gear includes salvaged, repainted Grail/Kazrak kit: ex-workers, not feral bandits. REFLAVOR GUARANTEED Knowledge Medium 15 to name the issue "That stone belongs in the ground." "You do not know what you are carrying." ADD EARNED A spared/captured reclaimer says monster attacks spiked when protection contracts went on sale. ADD EARNED Presence Medium 15; requires mercy or capture Instinct: spot ambush. Presence: parley/interrogate. Knowledge: recognize corporate-issue gear. ACT2 Act 2: Bramble ambush 90 0:55 to 1:30 1:30 first combat and possible interrogation Abstract the fight via a Group Action roll; keep one captured reclaimer for the interrogation seed.
- Mechanics: The party is in Act Two pressure: The party discovers clues that the strixwolf was not the whole story. Use Daggerheart Duality Dice as baseline. Use the listed Difficulty and outcome options when a roll matters. Keep trivial actions no-

roll; roll only when uncertainty, cost, or danger is interesting. s02-01-get-the-road-moving-again S02-01 Get the road moving again Get the road moving again Strength Finesse Strength Finesse 12 Strength moves the cart; Finesse fixes the wheel or pin. The Bramble Union watches while the party is exposed. Critical Success: best possible version of the action; gain Hope and clear 1 Stress. Add an extra benefit that follows from the fiction. Success with Hope: the PC gets what they wanted and gains Hope. Keep the position clean or generous. Success with Fear: the PC gets what they wanted, but the GM gains Fear and introduces a cost, complication, or pressure. Failure with Hope: the PC does not get the full result, but gains Hope and receives a useful thread, clue, or safer next option. Failure with Fear: the PC fails and the GM gains Fear. Make a hard move that follows from the fiction. The Bramble Union watches while the party is exposed. Use a hard...

- Roll Cards: s02-01-get-the-road-moving-again S02-01 Get the road moving again Get the road moving again Strength Finesse Strength Finesse 12 Strength moves the cart; Finesse fixes the wheel or pin. The Bramble Union watches while the party is exposed. Critical Success: best possible version of the action; gain Hope and clear 1 Stress. Add an extra benefit that follows from the fiction. Success with Hope: the PC gets what they wanted and gains Hope. Keep the position clean or generous. Success with Fear: the PC gets what they wanted, but the GM gains Fear and introduces a cost, complication, or pressure. Failure with Hope: the PC does not get the full result, but gains Hope and receives a useful thread, clue, or safer next option. Failure with Fear: the PC fails and the GM gains Fear. Make a hard move that follows from the fiction. The Bramble Union watches while the party is exposed. Use a hard complication, lost time, worse position, GM Fear, or mark Stress. Apply an official condition only if the fiction and rules justify it. The attempt falls short, but a partial thread appears. Offer one clue, weak position, or safer follow-up. The PC gets the core result, but it costs time, noise...
- Conditions Hazards: No official condition unless a feature, hazard, or fictional position calls for Hidden, Restrained, or Vulnerable.
- Search Loot Clues: No fixed loot. Offer clue, texture, or hospitality only when the fiction supports it.
- No Roll Guidance: Do not call for a roll when the players have time, a clear method, and no meaningful pressure.
- Tv Mechanics Caption: Public cue: The Fallout Investigation asks what the party does, what it costs, and who is protected.
- Trait Variety Note: Primary traits in this scene: Finesse, Instinct, Knowledge, Strength. If rolls drift toward Instinct/Presence, ask whether Agility, Strength, Finesse, or Knowledge better describes the action.
- Item Ids: tamsins-home-token cracked-pocket-ward
- Clueids: bramble-strand bramble-claim-marker torn-shipping-seals route-ledger tamsin-s-wedding-cord old-contract-tags bramble-are-criminals-noticetm
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- Image Asset Status: image_gen

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